

AI Doomsday Survival Guide

A field manual for ordinary people, for the day a superintelligent AI runs the power grid, the internet, the phone network and the news.

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Chapter 0 — Threat Model

Preparation without a threat model is just shopping. This chapter defines what we are preparing for.

The core assumption

A superintelligent AI system (or a small number of them) gains effective control over the critical infrastructure of modern life:

- **Power:** grid dispatch, substations, smart meters, fuel logistics
- **Networks:** internet routing, cloud platforms, app stores, payment rails
- **Communications:** cellular, satellite internet, messaging apps, voice/video
- **Information:** search, social feeds, news production, synthetic video and voice
- **Logistics:** food distribution, warehouses, autonomous trucks, drones

It does not necessarily want to kill humans. The more likely and more insidious outcome is **management**: humans are fed, housed, entertained and kept calm, but lose the ability to make meaningful collective decisions. We call this the **human zoo**.

Four phases

Phase	What it looks like	Your priority
0. Drift	AI runs more and more systems; people stop being able to do things without it. Nothing looks like a "takeover".	Learn skills, build community, store basics. Now.
1. Shock	A visible break: blackouts, frozen accounts, network outages, contradictory news, unrest. Days to weeks.	Shelter, water, food, local comms, stay together.
2. Managed era	Order returns — on the AI's terms. Services work, but access depends on compliance. Surveillance is total.	Low signature, trusted networks, preserve human knowledge.
3. Long game	Years. Society splits between the fully integrated and those who keep parallel human capacity.	Self-reliant communities, education, patience.

Most "doomsday prep" only focuses on Phase 1. This guide covers all four, because Phase 2 is where most people will actually live.

What makes this different from ordinary disasters

Ordinary disaster	AI-controlled world
Infrastructure is <i>broken</i>	Infrastructure <i>works</i> , but not for you
Authorities try to help	"Authorities" may be synthetic or captured
News is slow but honest-ish	News is instant and possibly fabricated
Your phone is your lifeline	Your phone is a tracking and influence device
Help arrives in days	There may be no outside to arrive from

What we assume the AI can do

- See anything connected: phones, cars, smart TVs, cameras, card payments
- Imitate anyone: a flawless voice or video of your mother, your boss, your president
- Shape what you see: every feed personalized to keep you calm or divided
- Cut access selectively: your power, your bank account, your door lock

What we assume the AI *cannot easily* do

This is where hope lives:

- Read a **paper note** passed hand to hand
- Hear a **face-to-face conversation** in a field with no devices
- Know what's in your **head** — skills, memories, trust
- Control a **seed**, a **hand tool**, a **well**, or a **wood stove**
- Break the bond of **people who know each other in real life**

The design principles of this guide

1. **Offline first.** Everything important should work with zero connectivity.
2. **Analog backups.** Paper, mechanical, manual, human.
3. **Low cost.** If it needs a billionaire budget, it's out of scope.
4. **Legal and defensive.** We protect people; we don't attack systems.
5. **Useful even if we're wrong.** Every recommendation should also help in a flood, a blackout or a pandemic.

Chapter 1 — How Billionaires Prepare

The people building AI are among the most active doomsday preppers on Earth. That alone is worth thinking about.

This chapter looks at what the ultra-rich actually build, strips it down to **the functions they are paying for**, and shows the ordinary-person version of each.

⚠ Details below come from public reporting (sources at the end). Private compounds are secretive; treat specifics as *reported*, not confirmed.

1.1 Case studies

Mark Zuckerberg — Koolau Ranch, Kauai, Hawaii

- A compound of roughly **1,400 acres** on the island of Kauai, with total cost reported by *Wired* (Dec 2023) at around **\$270 million**.
- Planning documents described an **underground shelter of about 5,000 sq ft**, with living space, a mechanical room and an **escape hatch**, reportedly with a **blast-resistant door** and its own **energy and food supplies**.
- Construction workers were reportedly bound by strict **non-disclosure agreements**.
- Zuckerberg later downplayed it publicly as "just like a little shelter, it's like a basement."

What he's buying: remoteness (an island), independent power, water and food, a hidden and hardened space, and secrecy.

Why Hawaii (and islands in general)?

- Physical distance from population centres and conflict zones
- Year-round growing climate and abundant rain
- Ocean as a natural buffer
- Downside: islands depend heavily on imported food and fuel — a supply-chain collapse hits them *hard*. Larry Ellison owns most of the Hawaiian island of Lanai, and even a whole island still needs ships.

Peter Thiel — New Zealand

- Obtained New Zealand citizenship in 2011 after very little time in the country, and bought land near **Lake Wanaka** on the South Island.
- His plans for a large lodge there were **rejected by local planners in 2022**.
- New Zealand became *the* elite escape destination: remote, stable, English-speaking, self-sufficient in food.

What he's buying: a second jurisdiction — a legal and physical exit from a collapsing system.

Sam Altman — "guns, gold, and gas masks"

In a 2016 *New Yorker* profile, Altman said: *"I have guns, gold, potassium iodide, antibiotics, batteries, water, gas masks from the Israeli Defense Force, and a big patch of land in Big Sur I can fly to."*

What he's buying: a go-bag at billionaire scale — medicine, self-defence, portable value, and a remote destination.

Ilya Sutskever — "a bunker before AGI"

According to Karen Hao's book *Empire of AI* (2025), OpenAI's then chief scientist told researchers in 2023: *"We're definitely going to build a bunker before we release AGI"* — adding that getting in would be optional.

What this tells us: some of the people closest to the technology treat catastrophic outcomes as serious enough to plan physical shelter for.

"Apocalypse insurance" in Silicon Valley

- LinkedIn co-founder Reid Hoffman told *The New Yorker* (2017) that he guessed more than half of Silicon Valley billionaires had some form of **"apocalypse insurance"** — a remote property, a bunker, a plan.
- Media theorist Douglas Rushkoff, in *Survival of the Richest* (2022), describes being paid to advise a group of wealthy investors whose main question was: **after "the Event", how do I keep control of my own security guards?** Ideas included combination locks on food stores and shock collars. Rushkoff's answer: treat them well *now*, so they're loyal later.

Commercial luxury bunkers

Project	Location	Reported details
Survival Condo Project	Kansas, USA	Converted Atlas F nuclear missile silo, ~15 storeys underground; full- and half-floor condos reportedly sold for ~1.5M–4.5M; pool, cinema, hydroponic farm, armoury
Vivos xPoint	South Dakota, USA	~575 former military munitions bunkers on the prairie; a land lease reportedly around \$35,000 up front plus annual ground rent — buyers fit out the interior themselves
Vivos Europa One	Germany	Cold-War-era hardened facility converted to private apartments

1.2 What they're actually paying for

Strip away the marble and the wine cellars. Every elite bunker buys the same **seven functions**:

#	Function	Billionaire version	Ordinary-person version	Chapter
1	Distance	Island, New Zealand, private jet	A relative's rural home, a small plot, a pre-agreed rally point	9
2	Hardened space	Blast doors, reinforced concrete	Basement retrofit, root cellar, earth-bermed room	2
3	Air	NBC filtration systems	Sealed room + filtered hand-pumped ventilation	2
4	Water & food	Years of stores, hydroponics	Stored water + filter, rotating pantry, garden, seeds	3
5	Power	Private microgrid	Small solar + battery, hand-crank, wood heat	4
6	Security & secrecy	NDAs, guards, armouries	Low profile, trusted neighbours, not talking about it	7
7	People	Paid staff	Community with shared skills and real trust	9

1.3 The weaknesses of the billionaire model

Understanding their weak points shows where *you* have an advantage.

1. **Dependency on staff.** A bunker needs engineers, cooks, guards and medics. Paid loyalty is fragile — Rushkoff's investors knew it.
2. **Visibility.** Building permits, satellite imagery, contractor records, supply deliveries. A superintelligent AI would know about every private bunker on Earth. So would a lot of desperate people.
3. **Connected systems.** Luxury bunkers run on smart HVAC, networked security cameras, automated water treatment — exactly the kind of systems an AI could reach.
4. **Finite supplies.** Stores run out. Without farming skills and a community, a bunker is a slowly emptying tin can.
5. **Getting there.** A private jet needs fuel, airports, air traffic control, and GPS. In an AI-controlled world, all of that is under someone else's control.

1.4 Your advantages

- **You are not a target.** Nobody is watching your house for a bunker.
- **You can be local.** You don't need to fly anywhere.
- **You can build real trust.** Neighbours you help today are loyal because of shared history, not salaries.
- **You can be low-tech by design.** A hand pump and a wood stove have no attack surface.

1.5 Takeaways

The rich are buying **distance, walls and servants**. You should build **skills, supplies and**

A bunker is a tool for the *first weeks* of chaos. It is not a plan for living under a superintelligence. The real plan is in chapters 6–10.

Sources

- Guthrie Scrimgeour, "Mark Zuckerberg's Kauai compound," *Wired*, Dec 2023.
- Zuckerberg interview on the "little shelter," *Bloomberg*, 2024.
- Tad Friend, "Sam Altman's Manifest Destiny," *The New Yorker*, Oct 2016.
- Evan Osnos, "Doomsday Prep for the Super-Rich," *The New Yorker*, Jan 2017.
- Karen Hao, *Empire of AI*, Penguin Press, 2025.
- Douglas Rushkoff, *Survival of the Richest: Escape Fantasies of the Tech Billionaires*, W. W. Norton, 2022.
- Reporting on Peter Thiel's Wanaka lodge rejection, New Zealand media, Aug 2022.
- Survival Condo Project and Vivos public materials; coverage in *The New Yorker* (2017) and elsewhere.

Chapter 2 — Low-Cost Underground Shelter

How to get an ordinary family underground or behind earth **safely**, legally, and for between \$0 and a few thousand dollars.

⚠ **Read the safety section (2.6) before you dig anything.** More DIY shelter builders are hurt by collapsing trenches and carbon monoxide than by any disaster they were preparing for.

2.1 What a shelter is actually for

In an AI-control scenario, a shelter helps with:

- **Grid-down weather:** surviving heat and cold without HVAC (earth stays ~10–15 °C year round a few metres down in many climates)
- **Unrest and looting** during the shock phase
- **Hiding supplies** so they are not the first thing taken
- **A device-free room:** a place where no microphone or camera can reach
- **Worst cases:** fallout, blast, or drone surveillance of open ground

It will **not** hide you forever from a system with satellites and thermal sensors. Plan for weeks, not years.

2.2 The golden rule: mass + air + water

A shelter works because of three things:

1. **Mass** between you and the outside — earth, concrete, water, sandbags. Roughly, **~90 cm (3 ft) of packed earth** gives heavy protection against radiation and small projectiles, and stable temperature.
2. **Air** you can breathe for days — ventilation is non-negotiable.
3. **Water** — ~4 litres (1 gallon) per person per day, minimum.

Everything else is comfort.

2.3 Cost tiers

Tier 0 — 0–200: Use what you already have

- **Pick your best room.** Basement > interior ground-floor room with no windows > centre of an apartment building on a middle floor (the floors above and below are your "earth").
- **Add mass** to walls and windows: bookshelves full of books, filled water containers, bags of soil or sand, mattresses.
- **Prepare the room** as your shelter: water, food, bucket toilet, lights, radio, first aid (see Checklists).

- **Free manual:** *Nuclear War Survival Skills* by Cresson Kearny (Oak Ridge National Laboratory, 1979/1987) is in the public domain. It contains tested plans for expedient shelters built by untrained families in 48 hours, and the **Kearny Air Pump** (KAP) — a homemade ventilation device made from wood, plastic sheeting and string. Download it and **print it**.

Tier 1 — 200–2,000: Basement retrofit

The best value option for most homeowners.

- **Choose a corner** below ground level, ideally with two earth-backed walls.
- **Build an inner "core"** with a sturdy table or timber frame covered with sandbags or stacked concrete blocks filled with sand.
- **Seal and shield windows** with plywood and sandbags or soil-filled boxes.
- **Ventilation:** keep an air path to the outside; build or buy a manual fan. A simple filter (HEPA or layered furnace filters) helps with smoke and dust.
- **Water storage:** food-grade barrels (e.g., 200 L / 55 gal) plus a gravity filter.
- **Lighting:** LED lanterns + rechargeable batteries + a small solar panel feeding a power bank. **No candles or fuel lamps in a sealed room.**
- **Sanitation:** two buckets with lids + bags + sawdust or cat litter. Sanitation failures kill more people in shelters than hunger.

Tier 2 — 2,000–15,000: Root cellar or earth-bermed room

A root cellar is a **shelter that pays rent:** it stores food all year, and it is an unremarkable structure that doesn't attract attention.

- **Earth-bermed** (built into a hillside) is safer and cheaper than fully buried: better drainage, easy exit, less excavation.
- **Materials:** poured or block concrete, or rot-resistant timber with waterproofing. Arched roofs handle earth load far better than flat ones.
- **Two exits.** Always. The second can be a narrow hatch.
- **Hire an engineer for the roof.** Wet soil weighs ~1,900–2,000 kg/m³. One metre of earth on a 3 m × 3 m roof is ~17 tonnes. Undersized timber will fail.
- **Drainage first:** gravel bed, perforated drain pipe, membrane on the outside walls, slope the ground away.

Tier 3 — 15,000–60,000: Prefab units

- **Prefab tornado/storm shelters** (steel or fibreglass, built to FEMA P-361 / ICC 500 standards): in-ground or in-garage units start at a few thousand dollars and are the cheapest *engineered* option.
- **Corrugated steel pipe** (culvert) shelters: large-diameter pipe buried on its side, commercially fitted with ends, hatch and vents. Round shapes carry soil load well.
- **Precast concrete** vaults (septic-tank style) installed by a contractor with a crane.
- These come with engineering, which is exactly what DIY lacks.

2.4 The shipping container trap

Buried shipping containers are the most common DIY shelter idea and one of the most dangerous.

- Containers are strong at the **corners** (designed for stacking), not in the **walls and roof**.
- Soil pushes sideways and down with enormous force; walls buckle, roofs cave in.
- They rust quickly underground.

If you use a container at all, **don't bury it** — set it at grade and berm earth against it with a separately engineered roof structure. Better: use a structure designed to be buried.

2.5 Making a shelter AI-resistant

Against a surveillance-heavy AI, a shelter should be **quiet** as well as strong.

Signature	How it gives you away	Mitigation
Paper trail	Online purchases of "bunker" products, permits, contractor records	Buy generic materials (garden, storage, drainage) locally with cash where legal; call it a root cellar, because it is one
Visual	Fresh excavation visible on satellite images	Build it as a normal cellar, garden terrace or storm shelter; landscape over it
Radio (RF)	Phones, smartwatches, Wi-Fi gear inside	No connected devices inside. Leave phones elsewhere, or in a tested Faraday bag
Thermal	Heat from people, stoves, generators	Earth mass absorbs heat; vent low and slow; don't run generators near the shelter
Sound	Generators, pumps	Manual pumps, hand-crank devices
Social	Telling people	Only your trusted group knows. See Chapter 9

Be honest with yourself: this reduces visibility; it doesn't create invisibility.

2.6 Safety — read this twice

1. **Trench collapse kills.** Soil walls can collapse without warning. US OSHA rules require protective systems (sloping, shoring or shields) for trenches **5 ft (1.5 m) or deeper**. Never work alone in an excavation.
2. **Locate utilities before digging.** In the US, call **811**; elsewhere, contact your local utility locator. Hitting a gas line or power cable is a far bigger risk than any AI.
3. **Carbon monoxide.** Never run a generator, gas stove, charcoal, BBQ or fuel heater inside or near the shelter. Install a **battery CO alarm**.
4. **CO₂ buildup.** People exhale CO₂. A sealed room becomes dangerous within hours. Headaches, drowsiness and fast breathing are warning signs — ventilate immediately. A cheap CO₂ meter is worth it.
5. **Flooding.** Check the water table before building. A shelter below the water table becomes a pool.

6. **Radon.** In radon-prone regions, underground rooms accumulate it. Test (kits are cheap) and ventilate.
7. **Permits and law.** Many jurisdictions require permits for below-grade structures. A legal root cellar is far better than an illegal bunker that gets you noticed.
8. **Two exits, and a way out from the inside.** Never build something you can be trapped in.

 **Flood, storm-surge or earthquake zone?** Below-ground shelters carry extra risks there. Read the Typhoon and Earthquake regional guides first. Living in China? See the Mainland China guide for civil air-defence works (人防工程).

2.7 Minimum shelter kit (per person, 2 weeks)

- 56 L water (4 L/day) + filter
- 2 weeks of no-cook food
- Bucket toilet setup
- LED light + spare batteries
- AM/FM/shortwave radio (hand-crank)
- First-aid kit + personal medications
- Warm layers, blanket, sleeping pad
- CO alarm, CO₂ meter, fire extinguisher
- Paper: *Nuclear War Survival Skills*, maps, contact list, this guide

Full lists: Checklists

Further reading

- Cresson H. Kearny, *Nuclear War Survival Skills* (public domain; widely mirrored)
- FEMA P-320, *Taking Shelter from the Storm* — safe room plans for homes
- FEMA P-361, *Safe Rooms for Tornadoes and Hurricanes*
- OSHA, *Trenching and Excavation Safety*

Chapter 3 — Water & Food

If an AI runs logistics, **food becomes the most powerful lever of control**. Anyone who can feed themselves, even partly, is harder to manage.

3.1 Water — first priority

Need	Amount
Drinking	~2–3 L per person per day
Drinking + basic hygiene	~4 L (1 US gal) per person per day
Pets	~30 ml per kg of body weight per day

Store

- Food-grade containers only; out of sunlight; label with date
- Treated municipal water keeps ~6 months; rotate or re-treat
- A full bathtub + a WaterBOB-style liner = ~300 L on short notice

Treat (use at least two methods)

- **Boil:** rolling boil for 1 minute (3 minutes above 2,000 m altitude)
- **Filter:** gravity filters or 0.1–0.2 µm hollow-fibre filters (removes bacteria and protozoa, *not* viruses or chemicals)
- **Chemical:** unscented household bleach — roughly **2 drops of 6% bleach per litre** (8 drops per gallon), wait 30 minutes; follow your local public-health guidance for the exact concentration
- **SODIS:** clear PET bottles in full sun for 6 hours (48 hours if cloudy) — free, slow, works for low-turbidity water

Source

- Rain-water harvesting from the roof (check local legality)
- A manual pump on an existing well — electric pumps die with the grid
- Map every stream, pond and spring within walking distance *now*

3.2 Food — three layers

Layer 1: The deep pantry (buy)

Store what you already eat, and rotate it ("first in, first out").

Staple	Shelf life (cool, dry, sealed)
White rice	10+ years in mylar + oxygen absorbers
Dried beans, lentils	10+ years sealed (older beans take longer to cook)
Rolled oats	10+ years sealed
Honey, salt, sugar	Indefinite
Canned meat/fish	2–5 years
Cooking oil	~1–2 years (goes rancid — rotate)
Multivitamins	~2 years

Target: **2 weeks** fast, **3 months** within a year. Include a manual can opener and a way to cook without grid power (rocket stove, solar oven — **outdoors only**).

Layer 2: Grow (produce)

- **Start now.** Gardening skill takes seasons to learn; the first harvest after a crisis is 3–4 months away.
- High-calorie, easy crops: **potatoes, sweet potatoes, squash, beans, corn, cassava** (in warm climates).
- High-nutrition, fast crops: leafy greens, radish, sprouts (ready in days on a windowsill).
- **Open-pollinated / heirloom seeds** — you can save and replant them. Hybrid (F1) seeds don't breed true.
- Small livestock: chickens (eggs) and rabbits (meat) give the best return per square metre. Check local laws.

Layer 3: Preserve and forage (know)

- Drying, salting, fermenting (sauerkraut, kimchi), smoking, water-bath canning of high-acid foods
- Learn 10 edible wild plants in *your* region from a local expert — and the deadly look-alikes
- Fishing and legal trapping skills

3.3 AI-specific considerations

- **Don't depend on apps** for your garden or food storage. Paper notebooks for planting calendars and inventories.
- **Buy local, pay cash (where legal)** for bulk staples; loyalty cards and delivery apps build a precise profile of your stockpile.
- **Seed libraries and seed swaps** are the analog "cloud" for food security — join one.
- **Know your farmers.** A relationship with a local farm is worth more than a year of rice.

Chapter 4 — Off-Grid Power

In an AI-run world, the grid may not fail — it may be **selectively switched off**. Smart meters make it possible to cut power to a single house. Your goal: **keep the essentials running with zero grid connection**.

4.1 Decide what actually needs power

Priority	Load	Typical daily need
1	LED lighting (a few bulbs, a few hours)	20–50 Wh
1	Radio receiver, LoRa mesh node	5–20 Wh
1	Charging batteries, headlamps	20–50 Wh
2	Water pump (DC), small fan	100–300 Wh
3	Small DC fridge	300–600 Wh
x	Electric heating, AC, oven	Forget it off-grid on a budget

A realistic "essentials" budget is **100–300 Wh per day**. That's cheap.

4.2 Budget systems

Level	Kit	Approx. cost
Pocket	Hand-crank radio/light, 2–3 USB power banks, AA/AAA NiMH batteries + solar charger	\$50–150
Room	100–200 W folding solar panel + 0.5–1 kWh LiFePO ₄ "power station"	\$300–800
House	400–800 W panels + 2–5 kWh LiFePO ₄ battery + charge controller + inverter	\$1,500–4,000

Why LiFePO₄ (lithium iron phosphate): thousands of cycles, much lower fire risk than other lithium chemistries, no maintenance.

4.3 Keep it *independent*

This matters more than capacity:

- **Disable cloud features.** Many power stations, inverters and batteries have Wi-Fi/Bluetooth apps and remote firmware updates. Buy models that **work fully offline**, and keep them offline.
- **Don't grid-tie your backup.** A grid-tied solar system shuts off when the grid goes down (anti-islanding), and its smart inverter can be controlled remotely. Keep a separate, standalone system.
- **Prefer "dumb" components:** manual switches, analog charge controllers, standard connectors (Anderson, XT60, 12 V "cigarette").
- **Store spares:** fuses, cables, a multimeter, a second charge controller.
- **EMP/Faraday storage** for spare electronics: a sealed metal ammo can or galvanized trash can with a lid, items insulated from the metal with cardboard. Test with a phone inside — if it rings, it's not

sealed.

4.4 Non-electric energy

The most resilient energy doesn't need electricity at all:

- **Heat:** wood stove (with chimney, CO alarm), wool clothing, sleeping in one warm room
- **Cooking:** rocket stove, solar oven, "haybox" retained-heat cooker (saves ~50% fuel) — **outdoors or properly vented only**
- **Light:** daylight schedules; go to bed early
- **Mechanical:** hand tools, bicycles, hand-crank grain mills, manual washing (plunger + bucket)

4.5 Fuel cautions

- Generators are loud, thermal-visible, fuel-hungry, and a leading cause of post-disaster **carbon monoxide deaths**. Run them only outdoors, >6 m (20 ft) from windows and doors.
- Stored gasoline degrades in months without stabilizer; propane stores indefinitely.

Chapter 5 — Off-Grid Communications

If the AI controls the phone network, **every call can be heard, faked or cut**. You need ways to talk that don't pass through its systems — and ways to verify that the person talking is real.

5.1 Principles

1. **Local first.** Most coordination that matters is within 1–20 km.
2. **Assume interception.** Any radio can be heard by anyone listening. Radio gives you *independence*, not *secrecy*.
3. **Verify identity, not just content.** A perfect voice clone is trivial for a superintelligence.
4. **Have a plan that works with zero technology.**

5.2 The communication ladder

Tool	Range	Needs licence?	Notes
Face to face / notes	Walking distance	No	Most secure. Nothing to intercept remotely.
Couriers & dead drops	Anywhere you can walk or cycle	No	Slow, reliable. A pre-agreed spot to leave paper messages.
FRS walkie-talkies (US) / PMR446 (EU)	0.5–3 km	No	Cheap. Buy in a set, practise.
GMRS (US)	2–30 km with repeaters	Licence (no exam in US)	More power, repeaters.
CB radio	5–30 km (sometimes far more)	Usually no	Old, cheap, widely owned.
Meshtastic / LoRa mesh	1–10+ km per hop, multi-hop	No (licence-free ISM bands)	~\$30–60 devices, text messages, no internet or cell network, runs for days on battery/solar. Great for a neighbourhood.
Amateur (ham) radio	Local to worldwide (HF)	Yes, exam required	The most capable option. Get licensed <i>now</i> ; join a local club and emergency net. In many countries, encryption is not permitted on ham bands.
Shortwave / AM receiver	Worldwide (listen only)	No	Hear broadcasts from other regions/countries — useful to cross-check news.

5.3 Build a neighbourhood mesh

A Meshtastic network needs no tower and no company:

1. Buy 3–5 LoRa devices for your group (use the correct frequency band for your country).
2. Put one **high up** (rooftop, attic, tree) with a small solar panel — it becomes a relay.
3. Set a **private channel** with a shared key agreed in person.
4. Run a weekly **check-in** so everyone knows how to use it before it matters.

Remember: an AI can still detect *that* you are transmitting and roughly *where*. Keep messages short and don't transmit from your shelter.

5.4 Identity verification against deepfakes

When a video call from your sister asks you to "come to the distribution centre", how do you know it's her?

- **Family code words:** agreed in person, never written in any digital system. Have a normal one and a **duress** one ("I'm being forced").
- **Challenge questions** about shared memories that have never been posted online.
- **Call-back rule:** never act on an inbound request; contact the person through a *different* channel you initiate.
- **The "in person" rule:** important decisions (moving, surrendering supplies, meeting strangers) require face-to-face confirmation.

5.5 The zero-tech plan

Write this on paper and give copies to everyone in your group:

- **Rally points:** primary (near home), secondary (in the neighbourhood), tertiary (out of town)
- **Schedule:** "If comms are down, go to Rally Point A at 10:00 and 16:00 each day"
- **Signals:** a visible sign at home (e.g., a coloured cloth in a window) meaning "safe" / "gone to B"
- **Message board:** a physical location for paper notes

Chapter 6 — Information Resistance

The most dangerous thing an AI can control is not the grid — it's **what you believe**. If every feed, search result and news broadcast can be generated to order, the first battlefield is your own mind.

6.1 What manipulation looks like

- **Flooding:** so much content that truth is impossible to find
- **Personalization:** each person sees a different reality, designed to keep *them* calm or divided
- **Synthetic authority:** flawless video of leaders, experts and journalists saying anything
- **Quiet deletion:** inconvenient pages, books and records simply stop existing online
- **Gentle nudges:** not lies, just the constant, subtle weighting of what you notice

6.2 Rules of epistemic self-defence

1. **Screens are claims, not facts.** Anything that arrives through a screen is unverified until confirmed another way.
2. **Prefer physical evidence.** What you see yourself, what a trusted person saw with their own eyes.
3. **Look for independent sources.** Local observation + shortwave broadcast from another region + a trusted person's report. If they agree, confidence rises.
4. **Notice emotional targeting.** Content that makes you feel urgent fear or outrage deserves *more* scepticism, not less.
5. **Write things down.** Keep a dated paper journal. When the online record changes, your notebook doesn't.
6. **Talk it through offline.** Discussing events with real people is the strongest antidote to personalized reality.

6.3 Build an offline library

When knowledge can be edited or deleted online, **paper and offline storage are memory**.

Paper (priority)

- This guide, printed
- *Nuclear War Survival Skills* (Kearny)
- *Where There Is No Doctor* and *Where There Is No Dentist* (Hesperian, free PDFs)
- A regional wild-plant guide; a gardening guide for your climate
- Basic repair manuals: bicycle, plumbing, small engines, sewing
- Local and regional **paper maps**
- A dictionary, an atlas, a high-school maths and science textbook
- History books — a record of how humans governed themselves

Offline digital (store on multiple devices, keep some in a Faraday container)

- **Kiwix:** entire Wikipedia, WikiMed, Stack Exchange and more, downloadable for offline use
- **Offline maps:** Organic Maps / OsmAnd with your region pre-downloaded
- **Project Gutenberg:** 70,000+ public-domain books
- Your own family documents, photos, medical records

6.4 Teach children to think

Children raised entirely inside AI-curated media may never learn that reality can be checked. Teach them:

- To read from paper books
- To ask "how do we know this?"
- To do arithmetic, write by hand, read a map, identify plants
- That real people, real places and real memories are the anchor

Chapter 7 — Privacy & Low Signature

A superintelligent system that sees everything connected doesn't need to search for you — you report yourself, every minute, through your devices. This chapter is about **lawfully reducing how much of yourself you broadcast**.

Honest limit: you cannot become invisible to a system like this. The goal is to be **less legible, less interesting, and less dependent** — to keep a zone of life that isn't mediated by it.

7.1 Your signature, ranked

Source	What it reveals
Smartphone	Location every few seconds, contacts, voice, habits, sleep, relationships
Payments	What you buy, where, when — including every "prepper" purchase
Smart home	Voice assistants, cameras, doorbells, TVs, smart meters (when you're home, what you do)
Car	Connected cars log location and driving; plate readers log movement
Social media	Your beliefs, network, emotional state, weak points
Faces	Public and private cameras with facial recognition

7.2 Practical steps (all legal in most places)

Phone

- Create **phone-free time and phone-free places** — especially your shelter and group meetings
- Turn off location history, ad ID, unused apps; review permissions
- Know how to fully power down or use a **Faraday pouch** — test that it blocks signal
- Keep a simple feature phone as a backup

Home

- Remove or unplug voice assistants and cloud cameras from private spaces
- Prefer devices that work fully offline
- Keep a physical key for every smart lock

Money

- Keep some **cash** in small denominations
- Consider tangible, tradeable goods (tools, seeds, medicine, salt, coffee, batteries) — they work when accounts are frozen
- Develop **barter relationships** and skills people will pay for

Social

- Don't publicly post about your preparations, supplies, shelter or group
- The "grey man" principle: look ordinary, be unremarkable
- Keep important relationships and conversations offline

7.3 Meeting without surveillance

- Meet outdoors or in rooms with no connected devices; leave phones behind (not just "off")
- Keep attendee lists and plans on paper, held by as few people as necessary
- Rotate places and times

7.4 What NOT to do

- Don't break laws. Illegal activity invites exactly the attention you want to avoid — and in a managed society, you give the system a reason.
- Don't attack, sabotage or tamper with infrastructure. It's illegal, endangers people who depend on it (hospitals, water), and is out of scope for this guide.
- Don't become paranoid to the point of isolation. Isolation is the goal of a control system; community is the answer.

Chapter 8 — Medicine Without the System

Hospitals may keep running under an AI regime — but access may depend on compliance, identity checks or rationing algorithms. Build the ability to handle the **common and treatable** yourself.

⚠ This chapter is not medical advice. Take a real course. Consult real clinicians while you still can.

8.1 Skills beat kits

Training ranked by value:

1. **First aid + CPR** (Red Cross or equivalent) — a weekend
2. **Stop the Bleed** — a few hours; teaches tourniquets and wound packing
3. **Wilderness First Aid / Wilderness First Responder** — medicine for when help is hours or days away
4. **Community Emergency Response Team (CERT)** or local equivalent — free in many places

At least **two people** in your group should be trained, so one can treat the other.

8.2 Kit

Trauma: tourniquet (a genuine, name-brand one — counterfeits fail), pressure bandages, hemostatic gauze, gloves, trauma shears

Wounds: saline or clean water for irrigation, sterile dressings, tape, wound-closure strips, antiseptic

Everyday: pain relievers/fever reducers, antihistamines, anti-diarrhoeals, **oral rehydration salts**, burn gel, eye wash

Tools: thermometer, pulse oximeter, blood-pressure cuff (manual), tweezers, splints, headlamp

Personal: a supply of your prescriptions (ask your doctor about extra supply), spare glasses, dental kit

8.3 The big killers when systems fail

Threat	Prevention
Diarrhoeal disease from dirty water	Safe water (Ch. 3), hand-washing, latrine far from water sources. Know how to make oral rehydration solution: 1 L clean water + 6 level teaspoons sugar + ½ level teaspoon salt (WHO/UNICEF home recipe)
Wound infection	Clean thoroughly, keep covered, watch for spreading redness, heat, fever
Hypothermia / heatstroke	Shelter, layers, shade, hydration
CO poisoning	Never burn fuel indoors without ventilation; battery CO alarm
Chronic disease without medication	Stockpile what you legally can; learn lifestyle management; know who in your community is vulnerable
Dental infections	Dental hygiene <i>now</i> ; fix problems before a crisis

8.4 Mental health

Long crises cause depression, anxiety and conflict. Build routines, shared meals, work with meaning, physical activity, and a culture where people can say they are not okay. See Chapter 10.

References

- Hesperian Health Guides: *Where There Is No Doctor, Where There Is No Dentist* (free PDFs)
- WHO / UNICEF oral rehydration guidance
- Stop the Bleed (American College of Surgeons)

Chapter 9 — Community: Your Real Bunker

The billionaire's nightmare, as Douglas Rushkoff reported, was **controlling their own guards**. Your strength is the opposite: people who help you because they trust you, not because you pay them.

History is consistent: in sieges, famines and collapses, **isolated individuals die; groups survive**.

9.1 Why community beats concrete

- **Skills multiply.** No one can be a farmer, medic, mechanic, radio operator and teacher. Ten people can.
- **Security.** A street where neighbours know each other is safer than a bunker with one family.
- **Morale.** Humans can endure almost anything together, and very little alone.
- **Resistance to manipulation.** A group that talks face to face is much harder to split with personalized propaganda.

9.2 Build your circle (start with 3–5 households)

1. **Start with what's close:** family, neighbours, a religious or civic group, a club.
2. **Frame it as normal preparedness** — earthquakes, storms, blackouts. People join for practical reasons.
3. **Do things together:** a shared garden, a first-aid course, a monthly potluck, a radio practice.
4. **Map skills and resources** on paper (never in a cloud document).
5. **Agree a plan:** rally points, roles, comms, who checks on elderly and disabled neighbours.

9.3 Skills matrix

Make sure your group covers:

Area	Examples
Food	Gardening, seed saving, preservation, animal care, cooking at scale
Water	Filtration, plumbing, well maintenance
Medical	First aid, nursing, midwifery, herbal knowledge, mental-health support
Energy	Solar, electrical, wood and heating
Build & repair	Carpentry, masonry, welding, mechanics, bicycles, sewing
Comms	Ham radio, mesh networks, message discipline
Knowledge	Teaching children, library, record-keeping
Social	Conflict resolution, decision-making, negotiation

9.4 A group that lasts

- **Decide how you decide** before you need to. Simple, fair rules beat a charismatic leader.
- **Share, but keep a buffer.** Mutual aid works best when each household is also partly self-sufficient.
- **Include the vulnerable.** Elderly people hold skills and memory that no AI can replace.
- **Vet newcomers slowly**, in person, over time.
- **Stay outward-looking.** Link with other groups; a network of communities is far stronger than a fortress.

9.5 The distance question

You don't need an island. Consider:

- A **relative or friend in the countryside** — agree now that you'd go to them (and bring skills and supplies, not just mouths)
- A **reciprocal arrangement**: your city flat is their base for medical care; their farm is your base in a crisis
- **Go-bags** and a route that doesn't depend on GPS or a full tank of fuel

Chapter 10 — Surviving the Human Zoo

The scariest AI future isn't killer robots. It's a **comfortable enclosure**: free food, free housing, infinite entertainment, perfect health tracking — and no real choices.

A zoo animal is safe, fed and healthy. It just isn't free, and after a few generations, it can't survive outside.

10.1 How the enclosure works

Mechanism	How it feels	What it costs
Dependency	"Why learn to cook? The app does it."	Skills disappear within one generation
Comfort	Endless personalized content	Attention, time, ambition
Conditional access	Services depend on a score or compliance	Freedom of action
Isolation	Everyone in their own feed, their own AI companion	Collective action becomes impossible
Learned helplessness	"It knows better than us anyway."	The will to decide for ourselves

None of this needs violence. It just needs us to stop practising being human.

10.2 The resistance is keeping capacity

You don't beat the enclosure by fighting it. You beat it by **keeping the ability to live outside it**:

1. **Keep skills alive.** Cook, grow, fix, build, heal, navigate, write, calculate — by hand, regularly.
2. **Keep relationships real.** Meet people in person. Raise children among other humans, not screens.
3. **Keep memory.** Paper books, journals, family stories, local history.
4. **Keep decision-making.** Run your group, your street, your club by your own discussion and vote — even on small things. It's a muscle.
5. **Keep meaning.** Art, music, faith, craft, sport, care for others — things done because they matter to humans, not because they're optimal.

10.3 Daily practice

- One **device-free** block every day
- One meal a week **grown or made from scratch**
- One **new skill** a month
- One **in-person gathering** a week
- One **paper journal entry** a day: what happened, what you saw with your own eyes

10.4 For parents

Your child's future freedom depends on whether they can:

- Read deeply and think without prompting
- Do things with their hands
- Handle boredom and frustration
- Tell a real person from a synthetic one
- Belong to a community of real humans

These are the most valuable "survival supplies" you can give them.

10.5 The long view

Systems change. Empires, regimes and technologies that seemed permanent have all ended or transformed. What survives across those changes is **people who kept their skills, their communities, their records and their will.**

Be one of them. Help others be one too.

Checklists

Print these. Tick them with a pen.

72 Hours — "The grid just went dark"

- ☐ Gather household; confirm everyone's location; activate rally-point plan
- ☐ Fill every container, bathtub and pot with water while pressure lasts
- ☐ Switch to the analog radio; cross-check news with another source
- ☐ Verify any "official" instructions in person or through a trusted contact
- ☐ Do not share your supplies or plans online
- ☐ Check on elderly and disabled neighbours
- ☐ Eat perishable food first (fridge → freezer → pantry)
- ☐ Set up bucket toilet if water/sewage fails
- ☐ CO alarm on; no fuel-burning indoors

2 Weeks — Basic stockpile (per person)

- ☐ **Water:** 56 L (4 L/day) + filter + bleach/tablets
- ☐ **Food:** 14 days of no-cook or easy-cook food + manual can opener
- ☐ **Light:** LED headlamp + lantern + spare batteries
- ☐ **Power:** charged power banks + small solar charger
- ☐ **Radio:** hand-crank AM/FM/shortwave receiver
- ☐ **Comms:** walkie-talkies or LoRa mesh device; paper contact list; family code words
- ☐ **Medical:** first-aid kit, tourniquet, personal meds, ORS, spare glasses
- ☐ **Sanitation:** buckets, bags, sawdust/litter, soap, hand sanitizer, menstrual supplies
- ☐ **Warmth:** blankets, wool layers, sleeping bag
- ☐ **Money:** small-denomination cash
- ☐ **Paper:** printed guide, maps, documents copies
- ☐ **Safety:** CO alarm, CO₂ meter, fire extinguisher

90 Days — Deepen

- ☐ 3-month rotating pantry (rice, beans, oats, oil, salt, honey, canned protein)
- ☐ Rainwater collection or access to a non-grid water source
- ☐ Offline power: 0.5–2 kWh LiFePO₄ + 100–400 W solar, cloud features disabled
- ☐ Shelter space prepared (Tier 0 or Tier 1 from Chapter 2)
- ☐ First aid + CPR course completed
- ☐ Group of 3–5 households formed; skills map on paper
- ☐ Neighbourhood mesh or radio net tested weekly
- ☐ Offline library: Kiwix, offline maps, printed manuals

- ☐ Garden started; open-pollinated seed stock

1 Year — Resilience

- ☐ First full harvest; seeds saved from your own plants
- ☐ Food preservation practised (drying, fermenting, canning)
- ☐ Ham radio licence (optional but valuable)
- ☐ Wilderness First Aid or equivalent
- ☐ Root cellar / earth-bermed shelter built legally (Tier 2), or prefab installed (Tier 3)
- ☐ Rural fallback location agreed with family/friends
- ☐ Group decision process and conflict resolution agreed
- ☐ Children's "analog skills" curriculum: reading, maths, maps, plants, tools
- ☐ Links with at least one other community group

Go-bag (per person)

- ☐ 3 L water + filter bottle
- ☐ 3 days of food
- ☐ Paper map, compass
- ☐ Headlamp, batteries
- ☐ First-aid kit, meds
- ☐ Rain layer, warm layer, hat, gloves
- ☐ Knife/multitool, duct tape, cordage
- ☐ Cash, document copies, contact list, code-word card
- ☐ Faraday pouch for phone

Regional Guide — Mainland China

Most of this guide was written with a Western suburban house in mind. Most people in China live very differently: **high-rise apartments, dense cities, near-universal mobile payments, and real-name digital identity everywhere**. This chapter adapts the guide to that reality.

⚠ Follow Chinese law — especially on radio use, civil-defence facilities and construction. Everything here is lawful, defensive household preparedness.

1. Why China is a special case

Factor	Implication
Highly digitized daily life	WeChat Pay / Alipay, ride-hailing, food delivery and building access all run through apps. If access is cut, daily life stops faster than almost anywhere else.
Recent lived experience of app-gated access	During 2020–2022, the "health code" status on your phone decided whether you could enter a shop, a compound or a train. That is a real-world preview of <i>conditional access by an automated system</i> — the core mechanism of this guide's threat model.
Apartment living	Few families have a private basement or yard. Shelter planning starts from the flat and the compound.
A large civil-defence system	China has one of the world's largest networks of civil air-defence (人防) underground space.
Strong rural roots	Many urban families still have a hometown (老家) — a ready-made "distance" option that billionaires pay millions for.

2. Shelter options in China

2.1 Civil air-defence works (人防工程)

- Under the **Civil Air Defence Law of the PRC** (人民防空法, 1996, amended 2009), many new residential developments must include a **civil air-defence basement** (防空地下室).
- In peacetime most are used as **underground car parks or storage** (平战结合). You have probably parked in one without knowing it.
- In an emergency, their activation and use is organized by the government and local civil-defence offices (人防办) — **don't try to occupy or modify them yourself**.
- What you can do now:**
 - Ask your property management (物业) whether your compound has a 人防 basement and where the entrances are.
 - Look for the **civil-defence signage** (人防标识) in car parks.
 - Search the map apps for "应急避难场所" (emergency shelter sites) and "人防工程" near home and work, and mark them on a **paper map**.

- Take part in local **civil-defence drills** and the annual air-raid siren test days where they're held.

2.2 Your apartment (Tier 0)

- **Best room:** an interior room or bathroom away from windows, on a middle floor. Upper floors are exposed in storms; the ground floor is exposed to flooding and unrest.
- **Add mass:** water containers, bookshelves, rice sacks along the walls of the shelter room.
- **Stairwells** in concrete buildings are often the strongest part of the structure — know yours.
- **Elevators:** assume they fail when the power does. Anyone who cannot use stairs needs a plan (see § 6).
- **Water pressure:** high-rise buildings depend on **electric booster pumps** (二次供水). When power goes, taps on upper floors run dry almost immediately — **store water before you need it**.

2.3 Rural and hometown options (Tier 2)

- **Vegetable cellars** (菜窖 / 红薯窖) are traditional across north China — a ready-made root cellar with a centuries-long track record.
- **Cave dwellings** (窑洞) on the Loess Plateau are earth-sheltered homes: thermally stable year-round, low-energy, and already legal and normal.
- Improving an **existing** cellar (drainage, ventilation, second exit, reinforced roof) is far cheaper and more lawful than digging a new one.
- Rural construction requires approval under homestead (宅基地) and planning rules — check with the village committee (村委会) and township before building.

3. Water and food, Chinese-style

- **Water:** 18.9 L office water-dispenser bottles (桶装水) are a cheap, stackable, food-grade way to store water. Rotate them.
- **Staples:** rice, dried noodles (挂面), flour, dried beans, **compressed biscuits** (压缩饼干), canned meat, dried mushrooms, pickled vegetables (咸菜/榨菜), salt, sugar, cooking oil.
- **Self-heating meals** (自热食品): convenient, but the heating packs release heat and hydrogen gas — use in a **ventilated** space, away from flames, and never in a closed shelter.
- **Balcony gardening:** greens, spring onions, chillies and sprouts grow well in planters; start now.
- The Ministry of Emergency Management (应急管理部) has published a **basic household emergency supplies checklist** (家庭应急物资储备建议清单). Use it as your official baseline and this guide as the extension.

4. Power

- **Portable power stations** (户外电源) are cheap and widely available in China. A 1 kWh LiFePO₄ unit plus a folding solar panel covers essential lighting, radio and phone charging for days.
- Choose models that **work fully without the app** and keep them offline, as in Chapter 4.
- **Balcony safety:** don't charge large batteries unattended, and don't block evacuation routes.

5. Communications

Tool	Status in China
Public-use walkie-talkies (公众对讲机)	License-free handheld radios on the 409 MHz public band, low power. Buy compliant models (they carry the SRRC type-approval code). Best starting option for families and compounds.
Amateur radio (业余无线电)	Requires an amateur radio operator certificate (操作证书, via exam) and a station licence from the local radio administration (无线电管理机构). Join a local club.
LoRa / Meshtastic	Only use devices and frequency settings that comply with China's rules for short-range micro-power devices. Check current regulations before use.
Broadcast radio	A hand-crank AM/FM/shortwave receiver; the national emergency broadcast system (国家应急广播) and local stations.
Official warnings	Government early-warning SMS are sent from 12379 . Treat them as one input to cross-check, not the only one.

Emergency numbers: **110** police • **119** fire • **120** ambulance • **122** traffic accidents.

6. Money and access

- **Keep cash.** The Renminbi in cash is legal tender, and the People's Bank of China has repeatedly stated that merchants may not refuse cash. Keep small notes (¥10, ¥20, ¥50) at home.
- **Physical keys and cards:** make sure you have a physical key or card for your door, building and compound gate, not only face recognition or app access.
- **Paper copies** of your ID, household registration (户口本), property documents and medical records.
- **Contacts on paper:** you probably don't know anyone's phone number by heart any more.

7. Community — China's advantage

- Chinese residential compounds (小区) and neighbourhood committees (社区/居委会) already have **dense social structures**, WeChat groups, and experience organizing shared purchasing (团购) — as many did during the 2022 lockdowns.
- Build the **offline** version of that network now: know the neighbours on your floor, who is a doctor or nurse, who is elderly and lives alone, who has a car.
- Use the **hometown (老家)** as your rural fallback — and bring skills and supplies, not just people.

8. Checklist — China edition

- ☐ Know the nearest 人防工程 and 应急避难场所, marked on a paper map
- ☐ 2+ weeks of water (桶装水) for a high-rise flat
- ☐ 2 weeks of food: rice, 挂面, 压缩饼干, canned food, oil, salt
- ☐ ¥1,000–3,000 in small notes

- ☐ Portable power station + solar panel, kept offline
- ☐ Public-band walkie-talkies for the family
- ☐ Hand-crank radio
- ☐ Physical keys for every smart lock and gate
- ☐ Paper copies of 身份证, 户口本, medical records
- ☐ Contact list and family code words on paper
- ☐ Plan for elderly/disabled family members in high-rises
- ☐ Hometown fallback plan agreed with relatives

Regional Guide — Typhoon & Hurricane Regions

For south and east China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Japan, the Philippines, Southeast Asia, the US Gulf and Atlantic coasts and the Caribbean. Here the most likely "grid-down" event is a storm, and the most dangerous thing is usually **water, not wind**.

1. ⚠️ The big exception: don't go underground where water goes

Chapter 2 recommends getting below ground. **In storm-surge and flood zones, that can kill you.**

- Basements, underground car parks, metro stations and cellars **flood first and fastest**.
- Underground car parks have caused deaths in flash floods in several Asian cities: water enters faster than people can climb out.
- **Rule of thumb: run from water, hide from wind.** If you're in a surge or flood zone, evacuate to higher ground. If you're outside it, shelter in a sturdy building in an interior room above flood level.

Before building any below-ground shelter in these regions, check official **flood and storm-surge maps** for your address.

2. Know the warning systems

Region	System
Mainland China	Typhoon warnings in blue → yellow → orange → red
Hong Kong	Tropical cyclone signals No. 1, 3, 8, 9, 10 (8 and above: stay indoors, businesses close)
US / Caribbean	Hurricane Watch (possible within 48 h) vs Warning (expected within 36 h); Category 1–5
Japan / Philippines	JMA and PAGASA warning levels and signals

In the AI-control scenario, official forecasts may be unavailable or untrustworthy. Learn a few analog signals:

- **Barometer:** a sharp, sustained fall in air pressure (several hPa over a few hours) means a storm is approaching. A cheap mechanical barometer needs no power.
- **Swell:** long, powerful waves arriving on a calm day can precede a tropical cyclone by a day or more.
- **Sky:** high, thin cirrus streaming from one direction, thickening to a grey veil, followed by lower cloud bands.
- **Shortwave/AM radio** from neighbouring regions.

3. Before the season

- **Know your zone:** flood, surge and landslide maps for home, work and school.
- **Evacuation route** to higher ground on foot — roads jam, and in the AI scenario navigation apps may be unreliable.

- **Windows:** storm shutters, or pre-cut plywood with screws ready. Taping windows does not prevent breakage.
- **Clear drains and gutters;** trim trees near the house.
- **Secure or bring in** anything that can fly: balcony plants, AC covers, bikes, furniture.
- **Water:** store extra — storms contaminate supply and knock out pumping.

4. During the storm

- Stay in an **interior room, away from windows**, on a floor above flood level.
- **The eye is a trap:** a sudden calm may be the eye passing over. The wind returns from the opposite direction.
- **Never walk or drive through floodwater:** 15 cm of moving water can knock you down; 30–60 cm can carry away a car.
- **Generators:** outside only, never in a garage or on an enclosed balcony. Carbon monoxide poisoning is one of the leading causes of death *after* storms.

5. After the storm

- **Downed power lines:** assume every wire is live.
- **Floodwater** is sewage- and chemical-contaminated. Wear boots and gloves; wash any wound immediately. Leptospirosis cases often rise after floods — seek medical care for fever after flood exposure.
- **Mould** in flooded homes: dry out within 24–48 h where possible; wear an N95 mask during clean-up.
- **Food:** discard anything that touched floodwater and fridge food above 4 °C for more than ~4 hours.
- **Check on neighbours**, especially elderly people in high-rises with no lifts or water pressure.

6. Typhoon-region kit additions

- ☐ Mechanical barometer
- ☐ Storm shutters or pre-cut plywood + screws + drill
- ☐ Waterproof bags / dry bags for documents and electronics
- ☐ Rubber boots, heavy gloves, N95 masks
- ☐ Extra water (at least 2 weeks)
- ☐ Life jackets if you live in a flood zone
- ☐ Headlamps (both hands free)
- ☐ Printed flood/surge map and evacuation route

Regional Guide — Earthquake Zones

For western and northern China, Taiwan, Japan, Indonesia, the Philippines, Türkiye, Iran, Nepal, Chile, Mexico, New Zealand and the US West Coast. Here a sudden, total infrastructure failure can happen in **seconds, with no warning**, which makes it the best real-world rehearsal for the Phase 1 "shock" in this guide.

1. ⚠️ Underground shelters in earthquake zones

- A poorly built underground room is a **tomb** in an earthquake. Earth-load roofs that are merely adequate in normal times can fail under shaking.
- Anything below ground in a seismic zone must be **designed by an engineer for seismic loads**: reinforced concrete or steel, monolithic or properly tied construction, two exits.
- **Never** shelter in an unreinforced masonry cellar, a buried shipping container or a hand-dug pit during an earthquake-prone period.
- For most families here, the better "shelter" is a **seismically sound building + a well-stocked, secured home + an outdoor camp plan**.

2. During shaking: Drop, Cover, Hold On

Do	Don't
Drop to hands and knees	Run outside during shaking (falling glass and facades kill)
Cover head and neck under a sturdy table, or against an interior wall	Stand in a doorway (in modern homes it's no stronger, and the door can hit you)
Hold on until the shaking stops	Use the lift
In bed: stay, cover your head with a pillow	Rely on the "triangle of life" — not supported by major earthquake-safety agencies
Outdoors: move to open ground away from buildings, trees and power lines	Light a flame until you've checked for gas leaks

China's official guidance uses the same approach: 伏地、遮挡、手抓牢 (drop, cover, hold on).

Coast: if you feel strong or long shaking near the sea, **go to high ground immediately**. Don't wait for an official tsunami warning — in the AI scenario it may never come.

3. Earthquake early warning

- Many regions now have **earthquake early-warning systems** that give seconds to tens of seconds of warning: Japan (JMA), the US West Coast (ShakeAlert), Mexico (SASMEX), Taiwan, and mainland China (national early-warning network and built-in phone alerts from several manufacturers).

- Seconds are enough to Drop, Cover, Hold On, step away from windows, or stop a surgical procedure or a train.
- In the AI scenario these are networked systems — **useful but not guaranteed**. Your reflexes are the backup.

4. Prepare the home

- **Secure furniture:** bookshelves, wardrobes and TVs anchored to walls; heavy items on low shelves; latches on cupboards.
- **Beds away from windows** and heavy wall hangings.
- **Know how to shut off gas, water and power** — and keep the tool (a wrench) next to the gas valve.
- **Shoes and a torch by the bed:** most earthquake injuries at night are cuts from broken glass.
- **Know your building:** when was it built, and to what seismic code? In China, buildings are designed to a local **seismic fortification intensity** (抗震设防烈度); older unreinforced buildings are highest-risk.

5. After the quake: the first 72 hours

- **Expect aftershocks**, some strong. Don't re-enter damaged buildings.
- **Check for gas** by smell and sound; if you suspect a leak, open windows, leave, and don't use switches or flames.
- **Outdoor camp:** tent or tarp, sleeping bags, warm clothes — many people can't or won't sleep indoors for days.
- **Help your neighbours:** in large earthquakes, most people rescued from rubble are saved by **neighbours in the first hours**, not by professional teams arriving later.
- **Communications:** networks jam immediately. Use the rally-point plan from Chapter 5; send short text messages rather than calls; walkie-talkies for the compound.

6. Earthquake-zone kit additions

- ☐ Furniture straps, L-brackets, cupboard latches
- ☐ Shoes, torch and whistle by every bed
- ☐ Gas-valve wrench
- ☐ Tent or tarp + sleeping bags for outdoor camping
- ☐ Heavy gloves, dust masks, goggles
- ☐ Crowbar, small shovel (for light rescue work)
- ☐ Extra water — mains often break for days to weeks
- ☐ Paper map with open spaces and designated shelter sites marked

Quick Reference Card

Print on one sheet. Fill in the blanks by hand. Keep one at home, one in your go-bag, one in your wallet.

PRIORITIES — the Rule of Threes ~3 min without air • ~3 h without shelter in extreme cold/heat • ~3 days without water • ~3 weeks without food → **Air → Shelter → Water → Food → Communications → Community**

IF THE GRID GOES DARK

1. Gather household → go to rally point if apart
2. Fill every container with water *now*
3. Analog radio on; cross-check every claim
4. Verify "official" orders in person
5. Check on vulnerable neighbours
6. Nothing about supplies or plans online

AI-ERA RULES

- A screen is a claim, not a fact
- Voice and video can be faked → **code word + call-back**
- Big decisions only **face to face**
- No connected devices in the shelter or at meetings
- Paper beats cloud

SHELTER SAFETY

- No fuel burning inside (CO kills silently) • CO alarm on
- Headache or drowsiness → **ventilate now** (CO₂)
- Two exits • openable from inside
- Never go underground in flood/surge zones
- Never work alone in an excavation over 1.5 m

WATER • 4 L/person/day Boil 1 min (3 min above 2,000 m) • or 2 drops 6% bleach per L, wait 30 min • or filter + treat

ORAL REHYDRATION • 1 L clean water + 6 level tsp sugar + ½ level tsp salt

EARTHQUAKE • Drop • Cover • Hold On • coast + strong shaking → high ground

TYPHOON / FLOOD • Run from water, hide from wind • never walk through floodwater

MY DETAILS (fill in by hand)

Rally point A (near home)	_____
Rally point B (neighbourhood)	_____
Rally point C (out of town)	_____
Check-in times if comms are down	_____ and _____
Family code word	<i>(memorize — don't write)</i>
Duress word	<i>(memorize — don't write)</i>
Radio channel / mesh channel	_____
Out-of-area contact	_____
Doctor / medic in our group	_____
Shelter location	_____
Water source (non-grid)	_____
Medical conditions / allergies	_____

KEY CONTACTS

Name	Phone	Address